

Kylian Mbappe

The last few weeks have been rather tumultuous in the life of Kylian Mbappe. An open spat with Real Madrid manager Alvaro Arbeloa has fuelled uncertainty around his form. Despite leading the race for the Pichichi Trophy with 24 goals in La Liga and recording 15 more goals (a season-best tally) in the UEFA Champions League, the start to 2026 has been one of missed opportunities for Madrid and the French striker. He will finish without any silverware in his second season at his dream club.

But there is no denying class. Mbappe's previous performances at the World Cup have given us enough proof. So when the referee blows the whistle for France's first Group I match against Senegal, a ruthless version of Mbappe can be expected.

In just two World Cup appearances, the Les Bleus forward has scored 12 goals, putting him sixth on the all-time list. Another successful

campaign and he could already zoom past Miroslav Klose, who scored 20 across four editions.

But beyond individual honours, the upcoming World Cup will be a chance for the French national team to cement its place in history. Memories of the 2018 World Cup are still fresh, but the injection of youth and flamboyance makes the side a fan favourite at the event. Mbappe has the chance to showcase his leadership qualities and ensure his team's potential translates into results — and then into trophy success.

FRANCE

Age - 27

Club - Real Madrid

NT Appearances - 96

Goals - 56

Assists - 40

